



Competitive Analysis — Hindu Calendar & Panchang Apps

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Executive Summary

The Hindu calendar app market is served by several well-established players, most of which have been built over many years and have accumulated large user bases — particularly Drik Panchang, which is the category leader. The common pattern across all competitors is a heavy feature load: full Panchanga, Kundali, horoscopes, muhurta calculators, regional calendars, and often prayers and aarti content. This breadth comes at a cost — cluttered interfaces, aggressive advertising, and a steep learning curve for new users.

Tithika's opportunity is to occupy a clearly differentiated position: the most beautiful, most accurate, and most approachable tithi-first app. No ads. No astrology. No feature bloat. Tithika bets that a large segment of users — especially the diaspora and younger urban Indians — wants a calm, well-designed, trustworthy lunar calendar without having to wade through Kundali charts or Vastu compasses.

Market at a Glance

App	Rating	Scale	Positioning
Drik Panchang	4.6–4.8 ★	1M+ Android, 5.5K iOS reviews	Feature-complete but cluttered; ads on free tier
Shubh Panchang	~4.5 ★	1 lakh+	Clean UI, muhurta focus; thinner festival coverage
Hindu Calendar–Panchang	~4.5 ★	#1 in 50+ countries (iOS)	Simple and popular; limited advanced features
Tithi – Hindu Calendar	~4.3 ★	Niche, Android-only	Ad-free, basic tithi view; Gujarati/Marathi/Hindi only
Hindu Calendar (Android)	~4.2 ★	Moderate, Android-only	Balanced; offline; horoscopes; accuracy varies
Tithika (planned)	—	—	Tithi-first · no ads · programmatic moon · v1 scope

Competitor Profiles

1. Drik Panchang — Hindu Calendar			4.8 (iOS, 5.5K reviews) · 4.6 (Android, 198K reviews) ★ · 1M+ Android downloads
Platform: iOS & Android	Price: Free + ads; ad-free ■19/mo or ■199/yr	Category leader · drikpanchang.com	

Drik Panchang is the de-facto reference standard in the category, backed by a reputed website (drikpanchang.com) with decades of trust. Its Android app alone has over a million downloads and nearly 200,000 ratings — a scale no competitor comes close to. The feature set is encyclopedic: from basic Panchanga through Kundali generation, horoscope matching, and even a Vastu compass. For a devout user who wants everything in one place, it is the default choice. However, that same completeness is its biggest usability liability. Reviews consistently praise accuracy while criticizing the ad experience and interface complexity. It has no visual representation of the moon, and its onboarding assumes prior knowledge of Vedic concepts.

Strengths	Weaknesses / Gaps
✓ Undisputed accuracy benchmark — Drik calculation method, trusted by astrologers for years	– UI is dense and dated — information overload for casual or new users
✓ Full Panchanga: all 5 elements (Tithi, Nakshatra, Yoga, Karana, Vara) plus extended Dainika data	– Aggressive ads on free tier (full-screen interstitials between tabs); users delete the app over it
✓ Kundali generator (D1–D60 charts), horoscope matching (Ashta Kuta), Vimshottari Dasha	– No moon-phase visualization — tithi is a number, not a visual experience
✓ 10+ Indian languages: Bengali, Gujarati, Hindi, Kannada, Malayalam, Marathi, Odia, Tamil, Telugu	– No home-screen widget on iOS (Android has basic widget)
✓ Offline-first; location-aware for any city globally; DST support built in	– Privacy: collects identifiers and usage data for tracking and advertising
✓ Cloud sync across devices; festival reminders; export to ICS calendar	– iOS app last major feature update was 2019 (v1.4.4 in Oct 2024 was UI fixes only)
✓ Vastu compass, Prashnavali, Choghadiya, Hora, Rahu Kalam with countdown timers	– Onboarding assumes familiarity with Panchanga concepts — not beginner-friendly
✓ Active development: last updated February 2026	

2. Shubh Panchang — Hindu Calendar			~4.5 ★ ★ · 1 lakh+ daily users
Platform: iOS & Android	Price: Free (supported by ads)	Clean UI · muhurta-focused	

Shubh Panchang positions itself as the friendlier, more modern alternative to Drik Panchang. Its clean interface and emphasis on muhurta timings resonate with users planning important life events. It operates both as a mobile app and a web property, giving it dual reach. The app has earned loyal daily users, and the muhurta module is regarded as one of the best in the category. Its weakness is depth of festival coverage and the lack of the brand trust that Drik Panchang has built over many years. Some users have reported festival dates missing or incorrect, which is a serious issue for a devotional app.

Strengths	Weaknesses / Gaps
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✓ Cleaner, more modern UI than Drik Panchang — praised as beginner-friendly	– Festival coverage gaps reported by users (e.g., Dussehra missing in some versions)
✓ Strong muhurta feature: Gruh Pravesh, Marriage, Vehicle, Property muhurtas	– Ad-supported free model — not ad-free by default
✓ Full Panchanga: Tithi, Nakshatra, Yoga, Karana, Paksha, Choghadiya, Hora, Gowri Panchang	– Moon visualization absent — no programmatic phase rendering
✓ Rahu Kaal, Yamaganda, Abhijit Muhurta with location-aware timings	– No home-screen widgets
✓ Both Purnimanta and Amanta month systems supported	– Less established brand authority vs. Drik Panchang for accuracy trust
✓ Personalized horoscopes; festival and vrat notifications	– Location defaulted to Mumbai in some versions — city picker not always prominent
✓ Available on both platforms; web version at shubhpanchang.com	– English/Hindi/Gujarati only — narrower language coverage than Drik Panchang
✓ Active social presence (Instagram, YouTube, Facebook)	

3. Hindu Calendar — Panchang

~4.5 ★ · #1 in 50+ countries ★ · 2 lakh+ users (self-reported)

Platform: iOS (primary)

Price: Free

#1 in 50+ countries on iOS · simplicity-first

This app's top chart ranking across 50+ countries is remarkable and speaks to the power of simplicity — it gives users exactly what they need without overwhelming them. The App Store ranking puts it in front of a very large diaspora audience that is hard to reach organically. However, the app has not evolved significantly and sits between the power-user apps and a truly modern consumer experience. It is essentially a digital reference book rather than an engaging daily companion. There is no visual language of the moon, no notifications to keep users returning, and no widget for the lock screen or home screen.

Strengths	Weaknesses / Gaps
✓ Market rank: #1 in 50+ countries on the iOS App Store — enormous distribution advantage	– Feature set is comparatively thin — no Kundali, no advanced muhurta, no regional calendars
✓ All 5 Panchanga elements; auspicious timings and major festivals	– No moon phase visualization
✓ Offline-first operation; straightforward city/location selection	– No home-screen widgets
✓ Approachable for users new to Panchanga — streamlined, not overwhelming	– No notifications/reminders for festivals or fasting days
✓ Strong word-of-mouth from diaspora communities (UK, USA, Canada, Australia)	– Limited language support (primarily English + Hindi)
	– Less transparency on calculation method — accuracy harder to verify independently
	– Android presence is weaker than iOS

4. Tithi — Hindu Calendar

~4.3 ★ ★ · Niche / small

Platform: Android only

Price: Free, no ads

Ad-free · offline · tithi-focused · Android

This app is the closest conceptual cousin to Tithika in the market — it is ad-free, offline, and puts the tithi at the center of the experience. However, it is limited to Android, has a small user base, and has not invested in design or visual storytelling. Its existence validates the market appetite for a focused, ad-free tithi app, but it has not executed on the visual and UX quality that would make it a mainstream product. Tithika can learn from its positioning while dramatically outclassing it on design, platform coverage, accuracy, and depth of content.

Strengths	Weaknesses / Gaps
✓ Ad-free by design — stands out from most competitors on this dimension	– Android only — no iOS app; excludes a large part of the target market
✓ Fully offline — no internet required	– Small user base — limited social proof and community
✓ Tithi-first design philosophy — closest in concept to Tithika	– No programmatic moon visualization
✓ Supports Hindi, Gujarati, and Marathi scripts — good regional coverage for the languages supported	– Basic feature set — no notifications, no muhurta, no festival detail pages

✓ Lightweight and fast — low-resource device friendly	– Limited language support (3 Indian languages, no English)
	– No home-screen widget
	– Unknown developer — trust and long-term maintenance uncertain

5. Hindu Calendar (Android)		~4.2 ★ ★ · Moderate	
Platform: Android only	Price: Free	Balanced · offline · Android-only	

A solid, workmanlike app that serves the Android market well for users who want a balanced Panchanga reference without the complexity of Drik Panchang. It is not particularly distinguished in any one dimension but avoids major failure modes. Its horoscope section is a useful retention hook. It would not be considered a primary competitor to Tithika given its Android-only nature and lack of differentiating design investment, but it occupies the same casual-user space that Tithika aims to serve on both platforms.

Strengths	Weaknesses / Gaps
✓ Good balance of Panchanga detail and user-friendliness — approachable daily reference	– Android only — no iOS app
✓ Offline functionality — critical for rural India and areas with poor connectivity	– Accuracy should be cross-verified — not positioned as an authoritative source
✓ Includes personalized horoscopes in addition to calendar functions	– No moon visualization
✓ Festival calendar with key dates	– No notifications or reminders
✓ Generally reliable accuracy for daily use	– UI is functional but not modern or visually engaging
	– No home-screen widget
	– Limited language support

Feature Comparison Matrix

The matrix below compares the five competitors against Tithika v1's planned feature set. ✓ = fully present, – = absent, 'part' = partially implemented or limited.

Feature	Drik Panchang	Shubh Panchang	Hindu Cal –Panchang	Tithi App	Hindu Cal Android	Tithika (v1 plan)
Tithi (all 30)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Nakshatra	✓	✓	✓	–	✓	✓
Yoga + Karana	✓	✓	✓	–	part	–
Sunrise / Sunset	✓	✓	✓	–	✓	✓
Moonrise / Moonset	✓	✓	–	–	–	–
Moon-phase visualization	–	–	–	–	–	✓
Festival calendar	✓	✓	part	–	part	✓
Special tithi indicators	✓	✓	part	–	–	✓
Muhurta / Choghadiya	✓	✓	part	–	–	–
Rahu Kaal / Yamaganda	✓	✓	–	–	–	–

Notifications / Reminders	✓	✓	–	–	–	–
Home-screen widget	part	–	–	–	–	–
Offline-first	✓	part	✓	✓	✓	✓
Location-aware (GPS + city)	✓	part	✓	–	part	✓
Purnimanta / Amanta toggle	✓	✓	–	–	–	✓
Kundali / Horoscope	✓	✓	–	–	✓	–
iOS + Android	✓	✓	part	–	–	✓
10+ Indian languages	✓	–	part	part	–	part
Ad-free (free tier)	–	–	–	✓	✓	✓
Privacy (no tracking)	–	–	–	✓	part	✓
Open source	–	–	–	–	–	✓

✓ = present fully · – = absent · part = partial or limited

Strategic Implications for Tithika

Where Tithika Wins by Design

The competitive landscape reveals a clear white space that Tithika is positioned to own. No existing app combines: (1) tithi-first focus, (2) beautiful moon visualization, (3) ad-free free tier, (4) open source credibility, and (5) a modern consumer-grade design. Every competitor makes at least one significant trade-off that Tithika avoids.

- **No moon visualization anywhere.** Not one competitor renders the moon phase visually. This is Tithika's most immediate visual differentiator — it makes the tithi tangible.
- **Ads are a universal pain point.** The most-reviewed complaint across Drik Panchang (the leader) is intrusive advertising. An ad-free v1 is a genuine competitive advantage, not just a nice-to-have.
- **Complexity is a weakness, not a feature.** Users routinely complain that full-featured apps are overwhelming. Tithika's scoped feature set is a deliberate design bet — and the market evidence supports it.
- **Open source creates trust.** For a devotional app where accuracy is paramount, open source means the community can verify the calculations. No competitor offers this.
- **The diaspora is underserved.** Apps like Hindu Calendar–Panchang have proven diaspora appeal (#1 in 50+ countries) without doing anything special for that segment. A beautiful, English-first, location-aware app with programmatic moon rendering would resonate powerfully with diaspora users.

Where Tithika Needs to Earn Trust

- **Accuracy:** Drik Panchang is the accuracy standard. Tithika must match it and make that verifiable — the open-source Swiss Ephemeris foundation is a strong start, but it needs to be communicated clearly.
- **Festival depth:** Competitors have years of festival content. Tithika's v1 festival list (36 festivals) is solid, but users will compare edge cases. The list should be reviewed by practicing users before launch.
- **Language:** Starting with English / Hindi is appropriate, but Devanagari rendering must be flawless on day one — any script errors will undermine trust with devout users.
- **Brand credibility:** New apps lack the trust of a Drik Panchang (which has a 10+ year website backing it). Tithika should lean into its open-source nature and accuracy claims from launch.

Recommended Competitive Positioning

Tithika should position itself as **"the beautiful, honest lunar calendar"** — a contrast to the cluttered, ad-heavy incumbents. The tagline could be something like *"The moon. Nothing more."* or *"Your tithi. Beautifully clear."*

Segment	Best Current Option	Differentiator
Mass-market / power users	Drik Panchang	Full Panchanga, Kundali, 10+ languages
Modern / muhurta planning	Shubh Panchang	Clean UI, muhurta emphasis, web + app
Simple daily reference	Hindu Cal–Panchang	Minimal, popular, iOS-first
Beautiful lunar focus	Tithika	Moon visualization · ad-free · open source · Drik accuracy

Key Takeaways

- **Drik Panchang** is the authority to benchmark accuracy against — it is both the bar and the warning of what to avoid (ads, complexity, visual blandness).

- **No competitor visualizes the moon.** This is Tithika's most defensible and immediate differentiator at launch.
- **Ad-free is rare and valued.** Only niche, low-scale apps avoid ads today. Tithika's commitment to no ads at the free tier is a genuine market gap.
- **The diaspora market is proven and underserved** by beautiful apps. Hindu Calendar–Panchang is #1 in 50+ countries doing very little — Tithika can do far more.
- **Open source + Swiss Ephemeris** is the fastest path to accuracy credibility with the power-user segment that bloggers, priests, and community leaders belong to.
- **Scope is a moat.** Resist the temptation to add Kundali, horoscopes, or muhurta to v1. The clear, focused product is the differentiator — bloat is the incumbent's weakness.